

Board 1
East Deals
None Vul

♠ J 10 2
♥ 9 8 3
♦ J 10 4
♣ 9 6 4 2

♠ K 6
♥ A K J 10 5 2
♦ K 5 3
♣ A 10



♠ Q 9 7 4
♥ 6
♦ A Q 8
♣ K Q J 7 5

♠ A 8 5 3
♥ Q 7 4
♦ 9 7 6 2
♣ 8 3

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	Pass
Pass	Dbl	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			

4 ♥ by North
over-ruff. Otherwise you ruff with a small trump.

Now throw East in (you hope!) with the ♣ 10.

Fortunately East has to take the ♣ 10. Since he has nothing left but ♣s and ♦s he must lead one or the other. A ♦ lead will give you a trick with your ♦ K and a ♣ lead will allow you to ruff in dummy (West still has a ♣) and discard a ♦ from your hand.

Some problems are tougher than others, this being a tough one.

It was not a complete elimination since West still had a trump when you threw East in. However, it worked because East was out of both ♠s and ♥s.

South realizes that to make a takeout double, then jump in your own suit you must have a very good hand. So he bids the game. North plays 4 ♥. East leads the ♣ K, which you take with the ♣ A.

You have four losers. If you are thinking about leading toward your ♦ K you are delusionary. East has the ♦ A and you know it. Your best hope is to end-play East with the ♣ 10 and force him to break the ♦s.

Play one round of trumps with the ♥ A. You can't play any more because you will need an entry to dummy for the elimination.

Next play ♠ K, ♠ A and ruff a ♠ high.

Lead a ♥ to dummy's ♥ Q. East shows out. Play dummy's last ♠. West is now void, so if he ruffs you

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 4
♥ K J 9 5
♦ Q J 10 4
♣ Q 10 9 2

♠ J 10 9 7 5

♥ 7

♦ K 8 6 3

♣ K 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8
♥ Q 10 8 4 2
♦ A 9 5 2
♣ A J 8

♠ A K Q 6 3 2

♥ A 6 3

♦ 7

♣ 7 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠

Pass 4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South
a winner. But it will still prove to be useful.

Play the ♥A, then ruff a ♥ in dummy. Play a trump to your ♠A and ruff your last ♥.

You are in dummy, just where you want to be. Play the ♦K, and when East plays the ♦A don't ruff but instead discard a ♣ from your hand. You knew all along that he held the ♦A.

[showcards N:SJ,CK,C5,C3 S:S6,S3,C7,C6]

East is end-played, forced to either break the ♣s and give you a ♣ trick, or give you a ruff-sluff.

This was the toughest hand so far and the end-play depended upon your correct reading that East must hold the ♦A.

It also depended upon the defenders not switching to ♣s at the second trick. If West had decided to switch to the ♣Q you would have had no chance at all.

South is to play 4♠. West leads the ♦Q.

Unless West is real beginner East will hold the ♦A so you should not try the ♦K on this trick. And when West continues with the ♦J you should again duck in dummy, ruffing with an honor in your hand.

The contract is in danger if East holds the ♣A because you would have three ♣ losers to go with the ♦ already lost. One really good possibility is that East now has the lone ♦A and you can set up dummy's ♦K with a ruff.

So play a small ♠ to dummy's ♠9, (pulling the two outstanding trumps), and ruff another ♦ with an honor, hoping the ♦A drops.

Too bad, the ♦A did not fall so dummy's ♦K is not

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 9 4 3
 ♥ 8 5
 ♦ 10 8 5 3 2
 ♣ 7 6

♠ A J

♥ A Q 10 9 4 3

♦ J

♣ A J 9 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 8 5 2

♥ 6

♦ Q 9 7

♣ K Q 5 2

♠ 7 6

♥ K J 7 2

♦ A K 6 4

♣ 10 8 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

6 ♥

All Pass

6 ♥ by North

♥10 to dummy's ♥K, pulling the last trump as you enter dummy.

After hearing a limit raise, North's leap to 6 ♥ is, well, bold let's say. North plays 6 ♥. East leads the ♠5, West plays the ♠K.

Very bold in fact. The opening lead has exposed a ♠ loser in addition to your two ♣ losers. On the plus side dummy has an extra ♦ trick. You are going to have to try to throw East in with the ♣ suit, but you will have to be very careful with dummy's entries.

Win the ♠A, play the ♦J to dummy's ♦K and discard the ♠J on dummy's ♦A.

You are in dummy, so ruff the ♠7 with a high trump. Next play the ♥9 to dummy's ♥J. Both defenders follow, whew!

Back in dummy, ruff a ♦ with the ♥Q, then lead the

It would be great if you could ruff dummy's last ♦, then get back to dummy with a trump so you could lead a ♣ from dummy and finesse. But check your trumps. If you do that you will have no more trumps in your hand and East won't be endplayed because you have no ruff-sluff. The only thing you can do is to go ahead and play ♣s now, finessing into East and HOPING he has no more ♦s!

You were lucky, East had only three ♦s so your partial elimination worked.

But if it had turned out that East DID have another ♦, and led it, all would not be lost. You would ruff in your hand, play a trump to dummy, then take a second ♣ finesse. If it turned out the ♣K and ♣Q were in different hands you would make the slam.